

Outlook

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Follow-up: which card declines become complaints?

Hi all,

I may be joining dots that do not belong together, so please challenge the premise.

The same decline code can lead to a successful retry, an ATM attempt, a phone call or lost activity. Failure anecdotes are beginning to drive decisions, although retries and late posting may be making the problem look larger than the affected-customer population. The first extracts did not reconcile, which means source precedence and exclusions must be part of the answer.

Could the answer be that poor explanations drive complaints more than the decline itself? Or are we actually seeing that most declines recover immediately? I also do not want us to miss the possibility that repeat declines cluster by card state or channel.

This has returned because the previous answer was useful but not strong enough to become a standing rule. Use October 2023 as the new evidence point rather than recycling the earlier conclusion. The practical decision is which decline reasons need rule, message or service changes. Please send a model-ready table, data dictionary and an honest baseline; I need the exceptions and counter-examples, not only an average.

Work from transaction-level timestamps, channels, amounts, statuses and error context; ATM attempts, host responses, PIN attempts, blocked-card state and latency; monthly account snapshots, status events, limits, product enrolments and signatories; customer contacts, complaints and suggestions. The data does not contain merchant terminal logs or card-scheme dispute outcomes.

Regards